

August 20, 2026

BlueChoice HealthPlan of South Carolina
Provider Appeals Unit
P.O. Box 6170
Columbia, SC 29260

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Karan Gerhold (MRN MUSC8525637), Claim MUSC-ABA7-1

Patient	Karan Gerhold (DOB 1938-05-17)
MRN	MUSC8525637
Member ID / Group	BLU899650221 / GRP-80368
Claim number	MUSC-ABA7-1
Date of service	2026-05-17
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$541.09
Denial code	CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-10-02

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health submits this first-level reconsideration on behalf of patient Karan Gerhold (Member ID: BLU899650221, Group: GRP-80368) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-ABA7-1 for services rendered on May 17, 2026, at MUSC Health Ashley River Tower. BlueChoice HealthPlan of South Carolina denied the claim in full on July 4, 2026, citing CARC 16 and RARC N290: "Missing/incomplete/invalid rendering provider primary identifier," with the payer remark that "Claim cannot be adjudicated; required data element(s) are missing or invalid." MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and requests immediate reprocessing of the claim, as the rendering provider's National Provider Identifier was valid and present at the time of submission.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Gerhold is an 88-year-old established patient with a documented history of active conditions including ischemic stroke (I63.9, onset 2017), Alzheimer's disease, hyperlipidemia, anemia, and prediabetes. She presented on May 17, 2026, for an outpatient visit at MUSC Health Ashley River Tower, a campus outpatient hospital facility (Place of Service 22). The encounter was managed by rendering provider Sarah E. Whitmore, MD, and billed under CPT 99214, reflecting an office or outpatient visit for an established patient of moderate complexity. The primary diagnosis recorded was acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified (J06.9), with a secondary diagnosis of ischemic stroke (I63.9), consistent with her active medical history. The claim was submitted electronically on May 27, 2026, within ten days of the date of service.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The sole stated basis for denial is that the rendering provider's primary identifier was missing, incomplete, or invalid. MUSC Health asserts that this characterization is incorrect. Sarah E. Whitmore, MD, holds an active National Provider Identifier of 1447382910, which is a valid, enumerated NPI registered in the National Plan and Provider Enumeration System (NPPES). This identifier was included on the claim as submitted on May 27, 2026. A billing error of this nature, if it occurred at all, constitutes a correctable administrative deficiency rather than a clinical or coverage-based ground for outright denial.

Under generally accepted claims processing standards and applicable state prompt-pay obligations, payers are expected to identify specific, correctable deficiencies and provide the submitting provider a reasonable opportunity to supply missing data elements before issuing a full denial. A denial under CARC 16 and RARC N290 is appropriate only when the identifier is genuinely absent or invalid — neither of which applies here. To the extent BlueChoice's adjudication system failed to recognize a valid NPI that was present on the face of the claim, the appropriate remedy is reprocessing, not denial. MUSC Health is prepared to resubmit a corrected claim electronically if the plan identifies a specific formatting or loop/segment issue in the original 837 transaction, but no such detail was provided in the remittance advice.

The billed amount of \$541.09 reflects a single unit of CPT 99214 rendered under revenue code 0510. The plan's own allowed amount of \$305.51 confirms that the service is a covered benefit for this member during an active coverage period running through December 31, 2026. There is no clinical or coverage basis for non-payment; the only stated reason is administrative, and that reason is not supported by the facts of record.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that BlueChoice HealthPlan of South Carolina reprocess Claim MUSC-ABA7-1 and issue payment at the contracted allowed amount of \$305.51 for CPT 99214 rendered on May 17, 2026, by Sarah E. Whitmore, MD (NPI 1447382910). If the plan requires a corrected electronic submission to resolve a specific transaction-level formatting issue, we request that BlueChoice identify the precise loop, segment, or element in question so that MUSC Health may resubmit without delay. This reconsideration is filed electronically via MIM in accordance with the plan's stated appeal process and within the appeal deadline of October 2, 2026.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record